It happened while…

Pre-Intermediate · Week 6 · 4000 EEW 1, Unit 5 "The Jackal and the Sun Child"

What to do: Show it at the start of Day 1 and Day 2.

Day 1

Words and listening

Vocabulary file + Exercises p. 1

Day 2

Grammar, reading, writing

This file + Exercises p. 2

Day 3

Speaking and recap

This file, Day 3 pages

By the end of the week you can: **"I was walking home when I saw a fox." "While she was cooking, the lights went out."**

Let's learn! when / while

Day 2 · step 1

What to do: Read the box. Draw a long line (was walking) and a short arrow (saw) on the board.

A long action (was / were + -ing) + a short action (past simple)	
She **was walking** across a field **when** she **saw** a fox.	long + short
While she **was watching**, the fox **ran** into the trees.	while + long
While the vet **was working**, Nilufar **was waiting**.	two long actions

when + the short action · **while** + the long action

«Я шёл домой, когда увидел лису»: **I was walking** home **when** I **saw** a fox. Длинное действие и то, что его прервало.



"I **was walking** across the field **when** I **saw** a fox!"

Let's learn! One after the other, or at the same time?

Day 2 · step 2

What to do: Students say two sentences about the reading: one with when, one with while.

Look at the verbs

When I **saw** the fox, I **called** a vet.	first saw, then called
I **was watching** TV **when** she **arrived**.	she arrived in the middle
While I was doing my homework I **fell** asleep.	a comma after the first part

Look closer · **during** + a noun, **while** + a sentence:

during the lesson · *while I was in the lesson*

Murphy red, Units 14 (p. 38), 98 (p. 206), 105 (p. 220)

A comma when the sentence starts with when / while.

Say it together · What happened?

Day 2 · step 3

What to do: One student per picture, half with when, half with while. Then Exercises page 2.



take a shower · the phone ring



cook · the lights go out



play football · it start to rain



sleep · the alarm ring



ride a bike · fall



carry eggs · the dog jump

1 Say it

"She **was taking** a shower **when** the phone **rang**."
"**While** he **was cooking**, the lights **went** out."

2 Now about you

Tell a small accident: "I was ... when ..."

Irregular verbs · set 4

Day 2 · learn for Day 3

What to do: Say them twice, then cover the second line and test a partner. Homework: learn them.

keep	leave	lose	pay	read
kept	left	lost	paid	read

run	sell	send	sit	sleep
ran	sold	sent	sat	slept

Say it fast: the teacher says the verb, the class says the past.

Make a sentence with when: *I lost my keys when I was running.*

Quiz · sets 2–4

Day 3 · warm-up

What to do: Pairs test each other, then you check 5 students.

think	write	tell	find	give
bring	catch	fall	feel	hear
keep	leave	lose	pay	read
run	sell	send	sit	sleep

Say the past of each verb. Answers on the last page.

Story chain · A strange day

Day 3

What to do: Go round the class. If a student forgets when / while, the next student helps.

It was a normal Saturday. I **was walking** in the park **when** I **saw** something strange…

1 Continue the story, one sentence each

Every sentence uses **when** or **while**: *While I was looking at it, it started to move…*

2 Then write the end

In pairs: 3 sentences. Read them to the class; the class votes for the best end.

Find someone who…

Day 3

What to do: Everybody stands up and asks. A "Yes" needs one more question. Then 3 students report.

Did you fall while you were running?

Name: _____

Then: What happened?

Did your phone ring while you were sleeping?

Name: _____

Then: Who called?

Did you see something strange while you were walking?

Name: _____

Then: What was it?

Did the lights go out while you were watching TV?

Name: _____

Then: What did you do?

Did you lose something while you were traveling?

Name: _____

Then: What did you lose?

Did it start to rain while you were outside?

Name: _____

Then: Were you wet?

Did you laugh while the teacher was talking?

Name: _____

Then: Why?

Did you meet a friend while you were shopping?

Name: _____

Then: Who?

Mixed check

Day 3 · alone, then check

What to do: Students write the answers alone (5 minutes), then check together.

1. I ___ (read) when the phone ___ (ring).
2. While we ___ (play), it ___ (start) to rain.
3. ___ I saw the fox, I called a vet. (When / While)
4. I fell asleep ___ the film. (during / while)
5. Correct it: While I watched TV, my mom was arriving.
6. White tigers are very ___. (rare / wild)
7. The ball ___ down the hill. (rolled / relaxed)
8. Past: lose → ___ · send → ___
9. The stars were ___ last night. (visible / likely)
10. What ___ you doing at 9? (were / did)

Answers

For the teacher

What to do: Check the class answers.

Quiz: thought, wrote, told, found, gave, brought, caught, fell, felt, heard · kept, left, lost, paid, read, ran, sold, sent, sat, slept

Mixed check: 1 was reading, rang 2 were playing, started 3 When 4 during 5 While I was watching TV, my mom arrived. 6 rare 7 rolled 8 lost, sent 9 visible 10 were

Exercises and homework: the key is on the last page of the Exercises file.